

FROM THE EDITORS AND BUREAUX OF *The Franks / Taylor* · BROOKLYN × ATHENS

The FORECAST

THE MAGAZINE THAT EXPLAINS THE YEARS AHEAD • A PRIVATE EDITION FOR THE FRANKS/TAYLOR HOUSEHOLD

1 THE VISION
A man at forty-nine, a
manifesto in plain ink.

2 SIX Pillars
Artist, Builder, Investor,
Family, Vessel, Legacy.

3 THE FORECAST
Goals by domain — money,
art, place, body.

4 THE FOUNDATION
Eighteen receipts. The case
for the next chapter.

5 THE DAILY CODE
Ten tenets. Read first thing.
Read last thing.

6 FOR NICOLE
The pages reserved for her
hand.

7 THE FORECAST II
Her goals, sorted by domain.

8 FOUNDATION II
Her receipts, her record, her
wins.

9 JOINT VENTURE
Garvey, the houses, Nikki's
List.

10 CLOSING NOTE
A love letter. A signature.



always seeing forward



ten thousand hands



two homes, one fire



begin here

BUILD WHAT LASTS

Adrian Franks's blueprint for the years to come —
and why the second half of every page is reserved for
the woman he built it with.

+ *Co-authored. Annual. Updatable.*

Issue I of an ongoing edition.



-
- FEATURE 01
 - EDITOR'S LETTER
 - A. FRANKS
 - BROOKLYN,
MAY 2026
-

I am Adrian Franks. *The work is the heartbeat.*

Thirty-one years woven through design, advertising, and the arts.

Atlanta first, then New York for eighteen of them, and now a second home growing out of Athens, Georgia. I stand at forty-nine and I do not see a finish line — I see a runway.

I am a financially successful commercial artist building with the brands that move culture. I am an investor turning property into engines of B2B enterprise. I am a creative technologist building platforms that bridge talent, ideas, and opportunity for the community I call home. I am the man in the best shape of his adult life. I am the husband. I am the father. I am the legacy in motion.

Every brushstroke is intentional. Every digital pixel a piece of a larger masterpiece. This issue lays it down — what I have built, what I am building, what I will not stop building until it stands.

And the second half of this issue belongs to Nicole. Because no version of this future is mine alone.

— *A.d.*

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF
BROOKLYN x ATHENS
ISSUE I, 2026

02 The Six Pillars — *what I am building*

• FEATURE 02
• ADRIAN

i NO. 01 — PRACTICE The Artist A financially successful commercial artist & creator. Partnering with brands that move culture. Sold-out shows, a second eyewear line, the brushstroke as legacy.	ii NO. 02 — PLATFORM The Builder FRNK Brands at full power. AI creative platforms funded and shipped. The Athens studio finished. Lot 2 rising. Hubs that empower, not extract.	iii NO. 03 — CAPITAL The Investor Commercial real estate that fuels economic growth. Debt free. \$3M saved by retirement. A catalyst, not a buyer. Properties that become engines.
iv NO. 04 — KIN The Family Man A pillar of love and guidance. Saving for Garvey's future. Honoring the one in spirit. A legacy of love and prosperity built side by side with Nicole.	v NO. 05 — BODY The Vessel In the best shape of my adult life. Strength, resilience, well-being. A discipline that mirrors the inner resolve. A body equal to the vision.	vi NO. 06 — INHERITANCE The Legacy Platforms bridging talent and opportunity. Cultural infrastructure for the diaspora. An ecosystem where art and commerce thrive in unison. More service. More given.

03 The Forecast — goals by domain

• FEATURE 03
• ADRIAN

i FINANCIAL FREEDOM

- 01 Become *financially independent* within 2 years.
- 02 Erase the *IRS debt* — fully and cleanly.
- 03 Acquire *\$2,000,000* in personal savings.
- 04 Save *\$3M* by retirement. Save 10% of every dollar.
- 05 Save for *Garvey's future* — beginning now.

iii PLACE & PROPERTY

- 01 Build the *Athens studio*.
- 02 Build the *second home* on Lot 2.
- 03 Take more *vacations*. Travel more.
- 04 Curate spaces that *empower* — not extract.

ii CREATIVE PRACTICE

- 01 Get the *AI projects funded* — FRNK at full power.
- 02 Finish the next *eyewear line*.
- 03 More *sold-out* art shows.
- 04 Continue innovating — *always*.
- 05 Become part of the *top 5%* of earners in the field.

iv BODY, SPIRIT, SERVICE

- 01 Be *healthy* — strong, resilient, well.
- 02 Tune into the *spirit*. Daily.
- 03 Volunteer more — *give the gift back*.
- 04 Keep *calm and cheerful* through it all.

04 The Foundation — *already true*

• FEATURE 04
• ADRIAN

"The vision is not naïve — the man has done it before, and he will do it again."

i	Artwork in the Smithsonian National Museum of American History.	HONOR
iii	Two Addys — Gold (Publix Greenwise), Bronze (Florida's Natural).	AWARD
v	Eighteen years lived in New York City .	PLACE
vii	Two children — one on this earth, one in spirit .	KIN
ix	Two studios run — Red Hook and Brooklyn Navy Yard .	STUDIO
xi	Designed and produced a first set of eyewear .	PRODUCT
xiii	Designed film for Spike Lee — <i>Chiraq</i> , <i>Da 5 Bloods</i> , <i>Two Fists Up</i> , <i>She's Gotta Have It</i> , <i>Michael Jackson</i> , <i>Prince Block Parties</i> .	FILM
xv	Designed AI experiences for Bank of America , Fox FIFA , PepsiCo .	CLIENT
xvii	Sold work to more than 200 clients across 30+ years.	TRADE

ii	Named to Ad Age 40-under-40.	PRESS
iv	First in the nation to receive the Journeyman Graphic Artist Award .	AWARD
vi	Married Nicole in 2007 — and we are still here.	KIN
viii	Two properties owned — NYC and Athens .	PLACE
x	Became an inventor . Filed patents in eyewear technology.	PATENT
xii	Founded FRNK Brands .	CO.
xiv	Designed Moleskine collaborations — Black Gotham , <i>She's Gotta Have It</i> .	PRODUCT
xvi	Designed wearable experiences for major banks.	TECH
xviii	Learned the web in the '90s . Learned digital UX. Learned to vibe code . <i>Still learning</i> .	CRAFT

05 The Daily Code — *ten tenets*

- FEATURE 05
- READ FIRST
- READ LAST

A man *becomes* what he thinks about.

01 <i>Become</i> what I think about. Knock the rough edges off the mentals.	02 Use all my courage to <i>define</i> the goals — and to <i>achieve</i> them.
03 Carry the goals everywhere. Read at first light, read again before sleep.	04 Save <i>ten percent</i> of every dollar earned. Without exception.
05 Stop the negative thoughts at the door. Do not let them enter.	06 Do <i>more</i> than I have to do. Always give more.
07 Believe in self. Stop the excuses. Think only of reasons I <i>can</i> .	08 Act successful — until acting is no longer required.
09 Put the fuel in <i>before</i> you ask for the heat.	10 <i>Carpe diem</i> . Every brushstroke is intentional.

• FEATURE 06 • THE SECOND HALF OF EVERY PAGE

For Nicole.

— *pages reserved for her hand*

The vision in this issue is mine. The *life* behind it is ours. So the next pages are not about me — they are *for you*.

The structure mirrors mine: six pillars, the forecast, the foundation. But the words belong to you. Some pages have prompts to start the conversation. Some are blank on purpose — to be filled in over coffee, on a long evening at the kitchen table, or however you like.

This is Issue I. We update it once a year. *Whenever you are ready.*

06.i Her Six Pillars

• RESERVED
• NICOLE

i

NO. 01 — PRACTICE

The _____

Your work in the world. The thing you make, build, or shape that no one else can.

ii

NO. 02 — PLATFORM

The _____

What are you building? Nikki's List, of course — and what else? What's yours that lives beyond us both?

iii

NO. 03 — CAPITAL

The _____

Your relationship to money, ownership, generational wealth. What does freedom look like to you?

iv

NO. 04 — KIN

The _____

As mother, partner, daughter, sister, friend. The roles you choose, the ones you'd refuse, the ones you've grown into.

v

NO. 05 — BODY

The _____

What does your body need from you in this season? What does the spirit need? What does rest look like?

vi

NO. 06 — INHERITANCE

The _____

What do you want to leave behind? Who is it for? What story do you want told a hundred years from now?

06.*ii* Her Forecast

• RESERVED
• NICOLE

i FINANCIAL FREEDOM

What does *financial freedom* mean for you, in your own words?

What is *your number* — the figure that lets you stop worrying?

What do you want to *own*, in your own name, by what year?

What do you want to be free *from*?

iii PLACE & PROPERTY

When you imagine the *Athens house*, what do you see in it?

Where do you want to *travel* next, and with whom?

What's a place you've never been that's been *calling you*?

Where in this life do you most want *to be still*?

ii CREATIVE PRACTICE

What is *your work* — and how do you want it to grow?

What does *Nikki's List* need from you to win?

What's a project you've been *holding* that wants to come out?

What craft do you want to *master* next?

iv BODY, SPIRIT, SERVICE

What does your *body* need from you in this chapter?

What is your *spiritual practice* right now — or what would you like it to be?

Who do you want to *serve*? Where do you want to give back?

What word do you want as the *theme* of the next year?

06.iii Her Foundation

• RESERVED
• NICOLE

"What I have already done is the floor — not the ceiling."

i. HONORS Awards, recognition, the moments your name was called.	ii. WORK MADE The projects, the brands, the bodies of work that are yours.	iii. PLACES LIVED The cities and rooms you've made your own.
iv. LIVES TOUCHED Mothered, mentored, married, befriended. The relationships that built you.	v. SKILLS LEARNED The crafts you have grown — slowly, deliberately, against the odds.	vi. HARD THINGS DONE What you have survived. What you have outgrown. What you have refused.

09 The Joint Venture — *what we are building together*

• FEATURE 09

• A & N

• THE CENTERPIECE Garvey. A son raised by two artists. The future we are designing first. Every decision in this issue runs through him.		• ORIGIN 2007. The year we married. Still here. Still building. <i>The longest project of our lives.</i>
• BUREAU · NYC Brooklyn. Eighteen years deep. The brownstone. The studios. The schools. <i>Where we became who we are.</i>	• BUREAU · GA Athens. Two lots. One studio in motion. A second home rising. <i>The next chapter, in pine and brick.</i>	• HER VENTURE Nikki's List. Lifestyle and booking platform for women — Vogue meets travel guide. Editorial luxury, monetized through partnerships.
• HIS VENTURE FRNK. An AI creative platform routing the world's models through Diasporic culture. <i>The orchestration layer.</i>	• THE PROMISE Held. One on this earth. One in spirit. <i>Both belong to us.</i>	• THE PLAN Annually. Issue I, Spring 2026. Issue II, the year after. <i>A document we will be proud to leave behind.</i>

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THE END — FOR NOW

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COMPOSED

Set in DM Serif Display, Source Serif, and Archivo. Printed on
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Taylor.

• BROOKLYN × ATHENS •
• MAY, THE YEAR FORTY-NINE •